SCCS-NY 2026 Workshop — Participant Feedback & Questions

From Photos to Spatial Pattern: Large-Area Imaging for Coral Reef Conservation · American Museum of Natural History · 14 October 2026 · James J. Herlan

How to use this form

This form takes about 10 minutes, is anonymous, and every question is optional. Your answers will be used to improve the workshop, the app and its manual, and my teaching — critical comments are the most useful kind.

- **Ratings:** write a number from 1 to 5 in the Rating column (1 = strongly disagree, 3 = neutral, 5 = strongly agree), or N/A if it doesn't apply.
- **Open questions:** a few words is fine; specific examples ("slide about K and g", "Activity 4") help most.
- **Paper or online:** hand the printed form back at the door, or fill in a copy of this document and send it to jherlan@gradcenter.cuny.edu.

1. About you

This helps me see whether the level suited different backgrounds. Tick or circle all that apply.

Question	Your answer
Your current role	Undergraduate · Graduate student · Postdoc · Faculty / researcher · Agency or NGO practitioner · Educator · Other:
Your main field	
Experience with underwater or reef imaging (photomosaics, SfM, 3D models)	None · Some · A lot
Experience with spatial statistics (point patterns, K / g functions)	None · Some · A lot
Experience with R	None · Some · A lot
Have you worked on coral reefs or other benthic habitats?	No · Yes, in the field · Yes, with data only

2. The workshop overall

Rate each statement from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree).

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The workshop met the goals stated at the start	
I can explain how photos become a 3D model and a 2D map of a reef plot	
I can tell *how many* colonies (intensity) apart from *how they are arranged* (pattern)	
I can read VMR, Clark–Evans R and g(r) and say whether a pattern is clustered, random or over-dispersed	
I understand why different processes can produce similar patterns	
I see how these methods could inform reef monitoring or conservation	
The overall length was right	

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The balance of looking, listening and doing was right	
I would recommend this workshop to a colleague	

What was the single most useful thing you learned?

What was the least useful or most confusing part?

3. Opening observation activity

The photos and videos from Rapa Nui, with “I notice / I wonder” on the easel pad.

Statement	Rating (1–5)
Looking before any statistics helped me engage with the later material	
The images were clear and varied enough to spark questions	
The activity was the right length (it ran about 15–25 minutes)	
The talk connected back to what we noticed and wondered	

Which image or video stuck with you, and why? (its number from the corner of the slide is fine)

How would you change this activity (fewer images, captions, small groups instead of the whole room, something else)?

4. The talk

Large-area imaging, the 3D models, the statistics and the Rapa Nui results.

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The large-area imaging steps (survey, 3D model, 2D map, colony points) were clear	
The 3D model fly-through videos helped me understand the reefs	
The “In plain language” slides made the statistics accessible	
The technical statistics slides were at the right level for me	
The four candidate processes (random, habitat filtering, biotic clustering, both) made sense	
The results (DCLF tests, neighbourhood composition, “gradient of control”) were convincing	
The slides were readable (text size, figures, colours)	
The pace was right	

Pace overall: Too slow · About right · Too fast

Level overall: Too basic · About right · Too advanced

Which slide or idea needed more explanation?

Was anything unnecessary or could be cut?

5. Hands-on session: the app and worksheet

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The app loaded and ran without problems on my device	
The app was easy to use without instructions from the front	

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The worksheet instructions were clear	
Working in a small group helped	
The user's manual (web or PDF) was useful	

For each activity, tick how it went.

Activity	Too easy	About right	Too hard	Ran out of time
1 · Intensity is not pattern				
2 · Regular, random, clustered				
3 · The three real reefs				
4 · Pattern vs process				
5 · Neighbourhood overlap				
Debrief				

Which activity taught you the most? Which taught you the least?

Did anything in the app break, confuse you or behave unexpectedly? (device and browser, if you remember)

What would make the app more useful for your own teaching or research (another dataset, a feature, a download option)?

6. Feedback for the presenter

Honest critique of my teaching is welcome; it is the part I can change most directly.

Statement	Rating (1–5)
The presenter explained ideas clearly, without unnecessary jargon	
The presenter used good examples and analogies	
The presenter spoke at a comfortable pace and volume	
The presenter checked for understanding and invited questions	
Questions were answered clearly and respectfully	
The presenter managed time well across the session	
I felt comfortable participating	

One thing I should keep doing:

One thing I should stop or do differently:

One thing I should start doing:

7. Recommendations for future workshops

If you could change one thing about this workshop, what would it be?

What should be added? (a topic, a dataset, more time for something)

What should be cut or shortened?

Which follow-up would interest you? Tick all that apply.

☐ A hands-on session building a 3D model from photos (Metashape / Viscore)

☐ Annotating and segmenting reef images (e.g. CoralNet, TagLab)

☐ Point-pattern analysis in R with your own data (spatstat)

☐ Field methods: planning and running a large-area imaging survey

☐ Using these methods for monitoring or restoration (e.g. outplant spacing)

☐ Other:

Preferred format next time: Half day · Full day · Multi-day · Online · In person · Hybrid

8. Your questions

Ask anything we didn't get to, about the methods, the Rapa Nui reefs, the app, or careers in this area. I will answer by email if you leave contact details, or in a short follow-up note shared with everyone who attended.

Question 1:

Question 2:

Question 3:

Any other comments:

Optional: contact for a follow-up answer. Leave this blank to stay anonymous.

Name	Email

Thank you for taking part. The app stays live at jjherlan.github.io/rpn-spatial, with the user's manual at jjherlan.github.io/rpn-spatial/manual.html, and the data and R scripts are on Dryad (doi:10.5061/dryad.s1rn8pkp4). Contact: jherlan@gradcenter.cuny.edu.